UI/UX Group Project: Concluding Report

Redesigning two cybersecurity experiences: Sentinel (Cloudflare Dashboard) and the Cybercrime Reporting Portal

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1. Summary

Our group chose the cybersecurity domain and redesigned two products. **Sentinel** is a redesign of the Cloudflare Dashboard for security and IT administrators. The **Cybercrime Reporting Portal redesign** is for ordinary citizens who must report online fraud or harassment, often while stressed. The two products have very different users, but they failed in the same way: unclear language, hidden or risky steps, and little feedback about what the system was doing. Both redesigns fixed this with plain wording, visible status, built-in safeguards and easy recovery. Five peer reviewers evaluated the work, and all of them preferred the redesigned versions. Because the review sample is small and informal, we treat this as encouraging evidence, not proof.

2. The two projects

	Sentinel	Cybercrime Reporting Portal redesign
Original product	Cloudflare Dashboard	Existing national cybercrime reporting website
Main users	Security/IT admins, developers, enterprise admins	Citizens reporting fraud, impersonation, harassment
Core problem	Jargon, deep menus, split data, weak error prevention	Cluttered pages, legal text, confusing categories, no progress or saving
Situation of use	Time-pressured, high-stakes configuration	Emotional stress, often after financial loss or harassment
Redesign goal	Clarity, safety and control for admins	Calm, simple, reassuring reporting

3. How we gathered evidence

Before the peer reviews, Sentinel was analysed with a critical analysis of 18 UX parameters and Shneiderman’s 8 golden rules, a heuristic evaluation using Nielsen’s 10 heuristics, personas and a journey map, and an accessible version for low-vision and colour-blind users. The cybercrime redesign was assessed the same way by its team.

Five peer reviewers then evaluated the finished prototypes against the originals:

Reviewer	Project reviewed	Format	Approach
Arhaan Mulani	Sentinel	Audio	Summary verdict
Mayank Rane	Sentinel	Audio	Personal feedback by theme
Kavya	Cybercrime portal	Audio	Summary verdict
Parshva Bora	Cybercrime portal	Written script	Task walkthrough (anonymous report), original vs redesign
Soham Pawar	Cybercrime portal	Audio, about 9 minutes	Task walkthrough (fake social media profile), original vs redesign

The audio recordings were transcribed automatically, so a few words are uncertain. Only points that were clearly stated are used below.

4. Findings: Sentinel

Both Sentinel reviewers described the original Cloudflare Dashboard as confusing and the redesign as easier to understand. They raised the same seven points.

Theme	What reviewers said	Design change behind it
Plain language	Terms like zones, proxy and TTL were confusing in Cloudflare; the prototype's simpler wording and information icons explained each option	Plain-language mode, "i" tooltips, rewritten alerts
Unified view	In Cloudflare they had to switch pages to see traffic and firewall logs; the prototype shows both side by side	Combined live security overview
Faster rules	Templates, an "if this then that" format and a duplicate option made rule creation quicker; rules sit on one page	Rules screen with templates and Duplicate
Safety	Warnings before changing nameservers, including the missing email record, helped avoid a serious mistake	DNS safety check with a locked button
Recovery	The undo option let them reverse an action	Undo on every action
Organisation	Settings grouped as recommended, advanced and danger zone showed what needs attention	Risk-grouped SSL/TLS settings
Accessibility	Larger text, clear status indicators, high contrast, colour-blind-safe icons and text, screen-reader support	Accessible prototype with icon + text + border status

One reviewer described the redesign as more beginner-friendly, organised and reassuring. His main suggestion was to keep the interface simple while adding further explanations for advanced settings, so that both beginners and experienced users benefit.

5. Findings: Cybercrime Reporting Portal

Three reviewers used the same method: do a realistic task on the original site, then repeat it on the redesign.

Problems found in the original website

- The homepage is cluttered, so users did not know where to begin.
- The anonymous reporting option is hard to find and the instructions are overwhelming; people still wonder if their identity is protected.
- A wall of legal text led one reviewer to tick the consent box without reading it.
- Categories and sub-categories use unfamiliar terms, so users guessed which one applied.
- The suspect section had no way to say “unknown”.
- Allowed file types were not shown on the upload page.
- There was no message that progress was being saved, and no sense of how many sections remained.
- Some text was too small to read comfortably.

Improvements praised in the redesign

- A cleaner homepage with the helpline and the anonymous option clearly visible.
- Short instructions, and a terms summary with the full text available on request.
- A step indicator, and the form split into four parts.
- Searchable categories with plain examples; typing “fake profile” suggested the right official category.
- Options to enter a profile link or choose “I don’t know”.
- Automatic draft saving, a Save & Exit option, and a simpler header.
- Accepted file types shown, with a clear confirmation after upload.
- A review page where any section can be edited, and a reminder to call the helpline when a financial loss is entered.

The reviewers’ overall verdicts were strong: “clear, calm and quick”, and one said they would choose the redesign for a friend. One reviewer noted that choosing a category still took a little time, which suggests the examples could be shown earlier.

6. What the two projects show together

The originals were very different products, but reviewers hit the same four problems in both:

1. **Hard-to-understand language** (cloud jargon, legal and crime terms).
2. **Hidden or buried important options** (rules menus, the anonymous option).
3. **Little feedback or protection** (no saving message, no warning before risky changes).
4. **Too much information at once** (dense settings, crowded homepage).

Nielsen's heuristics applied in both projects

Nielsen heuristic	Sentinel	Cybercrime portal
Visibility of system status	Live status badges, check counters	Step indicator, auto-save message
Match with the real world	Plain-language mode	Everyday examples for categories
User control and freedom	Undo on every action	Edit on review page, Save & Exit
Error prevention	Locked DNS button, safety checks	"I don't know" options, file-type guidance
Recognition over recall	Templates, side-by-side data	Searchable categories, suggestions
Minimalist design	Risk-grouped settings	Simpler header, shorter instructions
Help and guidance	"i" tooltips	Timely helpline reminder
Accessibility	High contrast, large text, colour-safe icons	Larger text and clearer layout

Both redesigns apply one idea: **in a stressful, high-stakes task, the interface should reduce uncertainty.** Sentinel does this for administrators who fear a costly mistake, and the portal does it for citizens who fear being lost, judged or losing their work.

7. Limitations

- **Small, informal sample.** Five reviewers is enough to spot patterns, not to prove them statistically.
- **Reviewers are classmates.** They are not the real target users (security admins or crime victims) and may lean positive. Some recordings read like prepared presentations and mostly praise the redesign.
- **No numbers yet.** We did not collect task times, error counts or a standard score such as the System Usability Scale.
- **Uneven depth.** Two reviews followed a full task walkthrough, while others gave summary opinions.
- **Prototype scope.** Sentinel has five screens, not the full Cloudflare feature set, and the portal redesign is a prototype.

8. Recommendations

For Sentinel

- Add the missing areas (Zero Trust policies, Analytics, Settings) and a mobile layout.
- Add short explanations for advanced settings, as one reviewer suggested.
- Test with real security administrators or developers and measure task time and errors.
- Publish the prototype with Microsoft Clarity to see real clicks and hesitations.

For the Cybercrime Portal

- Test with people from different ages, languages and digital skill levels.

- Make the privacy promise for anonymous reports explicit, and show how a user can track a report.
- Move category examples earlier to cut selection time.
- Run an accessibility check (contrast, text size, screen-reader support).

For both

- Run moderated think-aloud sessions with at least five target users each.
- Use the same simple scale (such as the SUS) so the projects can be compared fairly.
- Share one component library and plain-language style guide across the two projects.

9. Conclusion

This project shows that good design matters most where the stakes are highest. Cloudflare's dashboard and the cybercrime portal protect people and systems, yet both made users feel lost, worried or unsure. By using plain language, putting key options in view, showing status clearly, preventing mistakes and letting people undo or edit, both redesigns turned stressful tasks into manageable ones, and every reviewer preferred them. The evidence is encouraging but limited, so the next step is testing with real users and measured results. A security product is only as strong as the people who can use it correctly, and both of our redesigns aim to help users do exactly that.